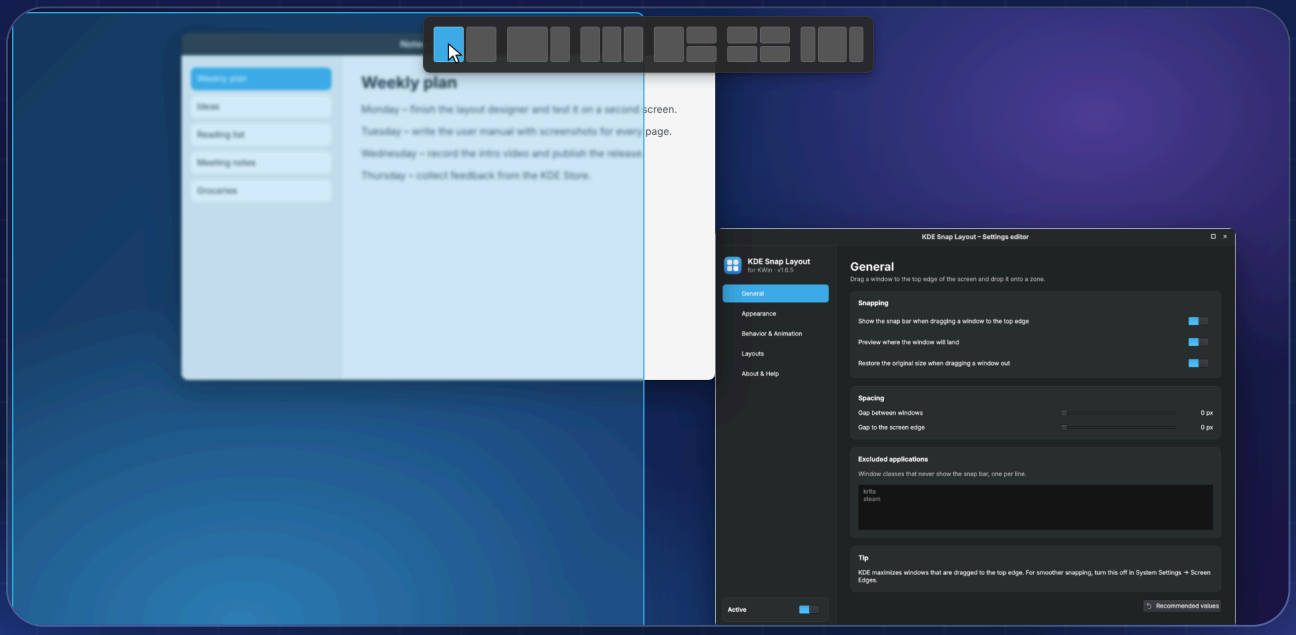
USER MANUAL

KDE Snap Layout

Snap layouts for KDE Plasma 6.
Drag a window to the top edge, drop it onto a zone – done.



Version 1.6.5
KWin script for Plasma 6 · Wayland & X11

Swenix-dev
github.com/Swenix-dev/KDE-Snap-Layout

Contents

Everything KDE Snap Layout can do, page by page – from the first snap to your own layouts.

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How to read this manual

1 Orange numbers in a screenshot point to a control. The list below the picture explains each one.

`Button` Grey labels are text you see on the screen: buttons, switches, menu entries.

`command` Monospaced text is typed into a terminal.

Tip
Ideas that make daily use quicker.

Note
Background information worth knowing.

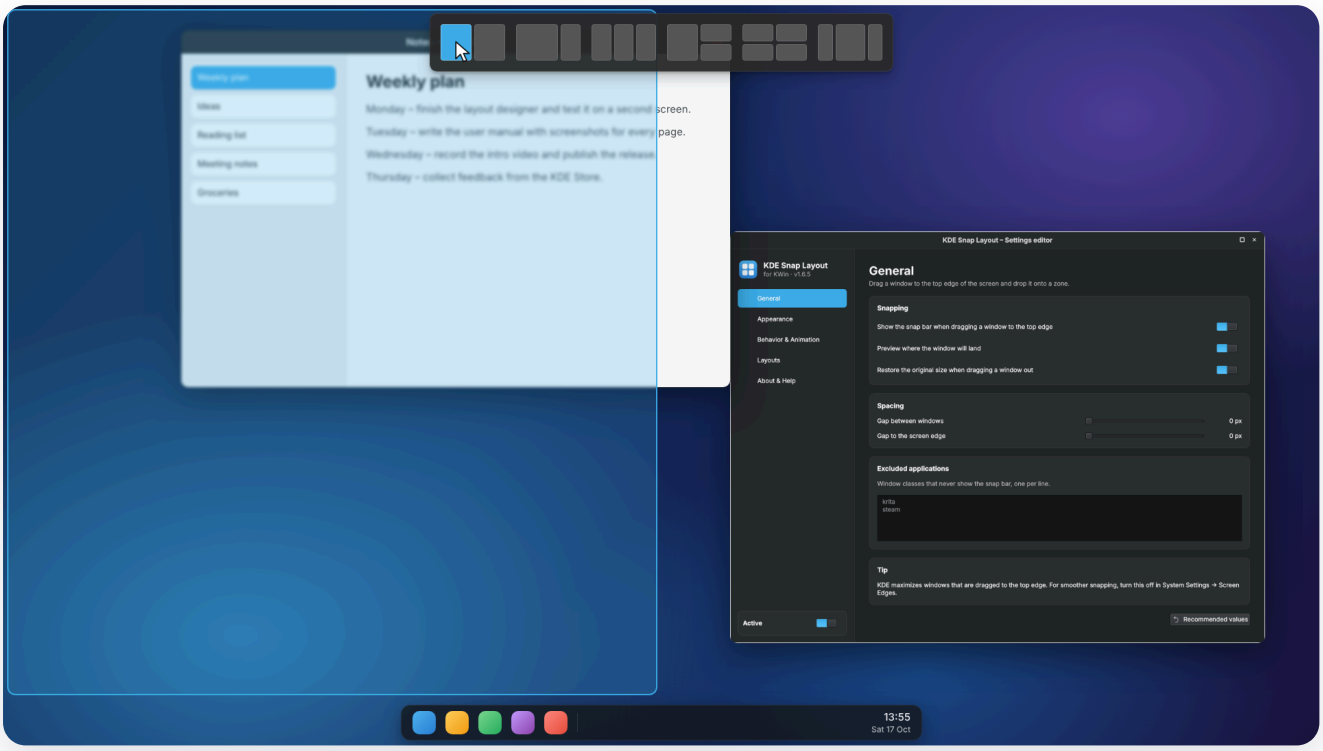
Important
Read this before you continue.

Screenshots
The pictures show the light Breeze color scheme in English. KDE Snap Layout always uses your own colors, window decoration and system language, so it may look slightly different on your desktop.

CHAPTER 1

1 Introduction

KDE Snap Layout brings snap layouts to KDE Plasma 6. Drag a window towards the top edge of the screen, a bar with layouts slides down, and you drop the window onto the zone where it should go.



Drag, drop, done

No shortcuts to learn – it works with the mouse movement you already know.

Your own layouts

Six layouts ready to go, plus a designer for any split you like – up to 16 zones.

Fits your desktop

System, light or dark colors, any accent. The editor uses your color scheme, decoration and language.

Feels right

Distances, delays, slide speed and six motion curves – every detail can be tuned.

Gets out of the way

Drag a snapped window out and it gets its old size back. Exclude apps you never want to snap.

Pure KWin script

No extra program running in the background. Install from the KDE Store with two clicks.

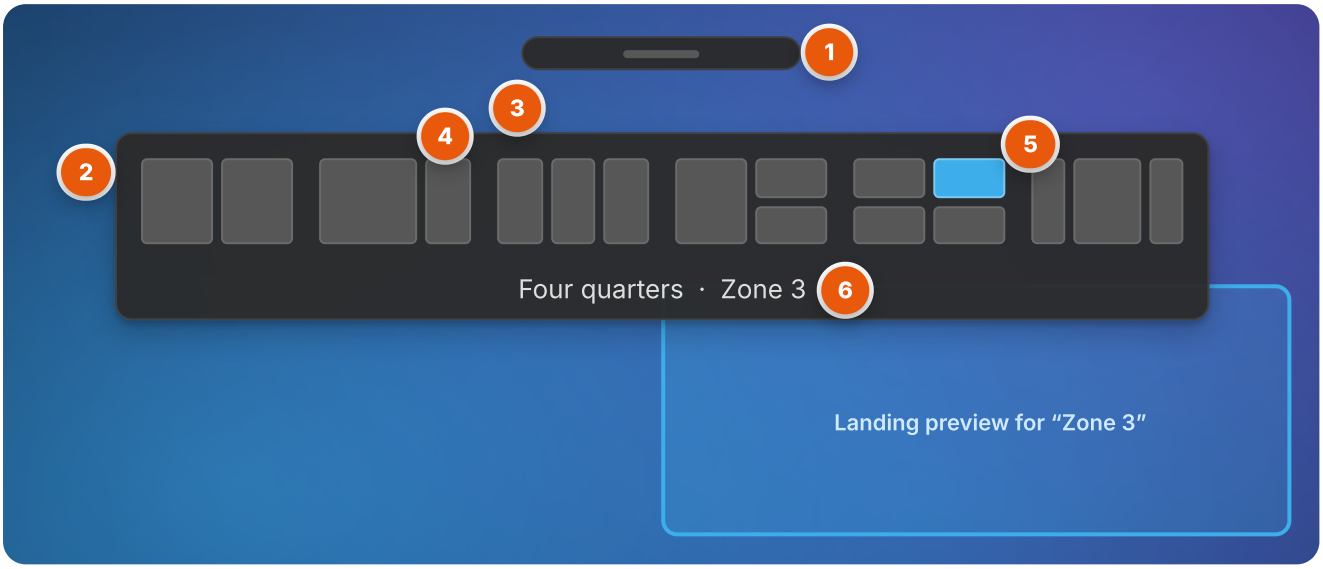
What is a “zone”?

A layout splits the screen into areas, for example two halves or three columns. Each area is a zone. The snap bar shows every layout as a small picture of the screen; each rectangle in it is a zone you can drop a window onto.

CHAPTER 2

2 The snap bar at a glance

The snap bar only appears while you move a window. It never takes space on your screen otherwise.

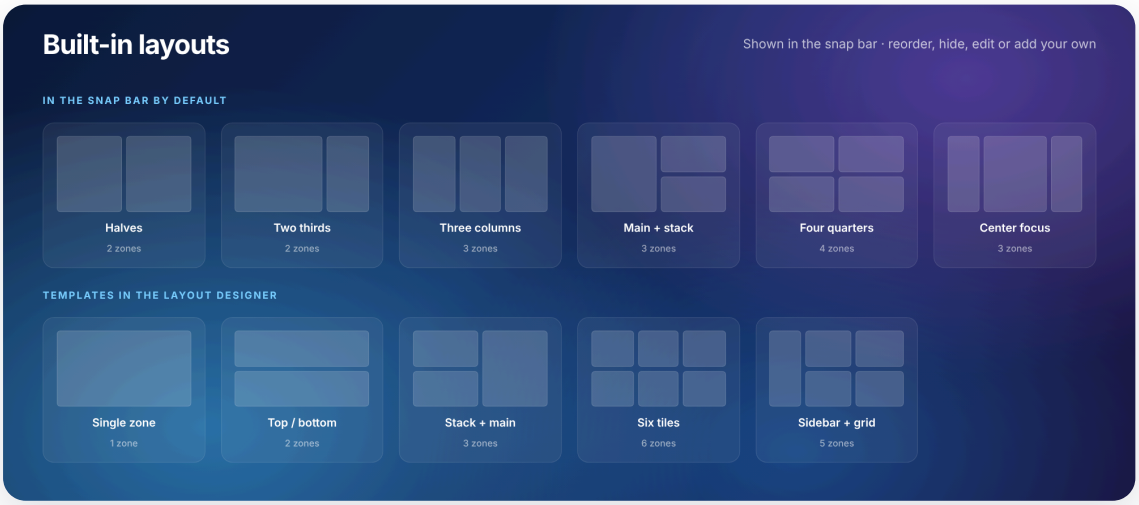


1. **Handle** – a small pill that appears first when the window gets close to the top. It tells you the bar is ready.
2. **Snap bar** – slides down once the cursor reaches the top edge. It always appears on the screen you are working on.
3. **Layout** – a small picture of your screen. The bar shows all layouts marked **In bar**.
4. **Zone** – one area of a layout. Hover it to select it.
5. **Highlighted zone** – drawn in the accent color. Releasing the mouse now snaps the window here.
6. **Name line** (optional) – shows the layout and zone name, e.g. "Four quarters · Zone 3".

The landing preview

While a zone is highlighted, a translucent rectangle in the accent color shows on the desktop exactly where the window will land – including gaps and panels. Move away from the bar and the preview disappears.

Built-in layouts



CHAPTER 3

3 Installation

KDE Snap Layout is a KWin script. It installs into your home folder, needs no administrator rights and adds no background program.

Requirement	Details
Desktop	KDE Plasma 6 (KWin 6) – Wayland or X11
Distribution	Any: Fedora, Arch, openSUSE, KDE neon, Kubuntu, Debian …
Extra packages	None – everything it needs ships with Plasma

Option A – KDE Store (recommended)

1. Open **System Settings** → **Window Management** → **KWin Scripts**.
2. Click **Get New…** at the top right, search for **KDE Snap Layout** and click **Install**.
3. Tick the checkbox next to **KDE Snap Layout** and click **Apply**.

Option B – file from GitHub

1. Download `kdesnaplayout-<version>.kwinscript` from the **Releases** page.
2. In **KWin Scripts** click **Install from File…** and choose the file.
3. Tick **KDE Snap Layout** and click **Apply**.

Option C – terminal

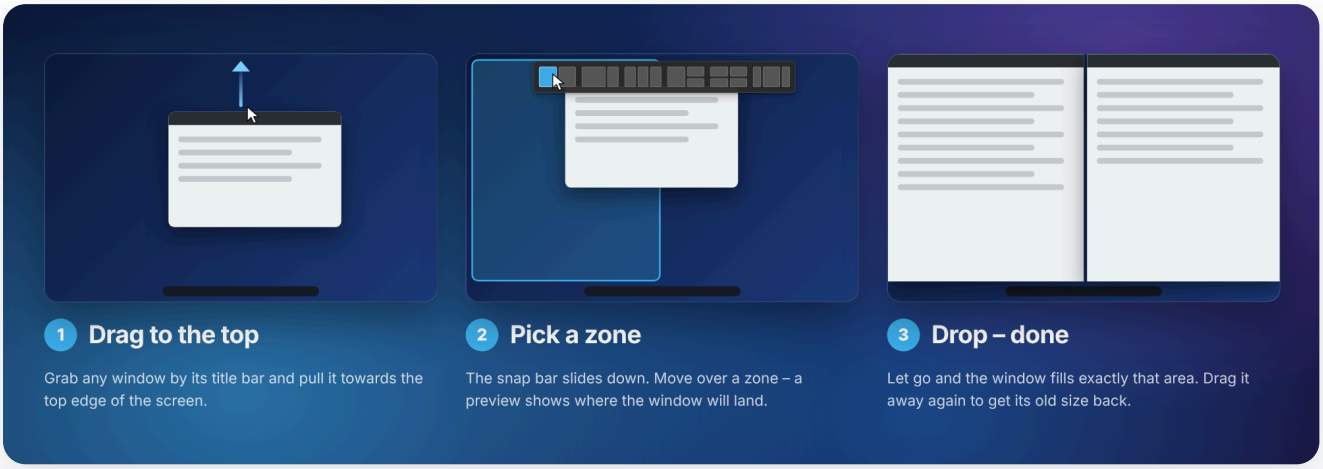
```
# install
kpackagetool6 --type KWin/Script --install kdesnaplayout-1.6.5.kwinscript
# update to a newer version
kpackagetool6 --type KWin/Script --upgrade kdesnaplayout-1.6.5.kwinscript
# switch it on
kwriteconfig6 --file kwinrc --group Plugins --key kdesnaplayoutEnabled true
qdbus6 org.kde.KWin /KWin reconfigure
```

> **After an update: log out once**
> KWin keeps a loaded script in memory. After installing a new version, log out and back in so the new files are used. You can check the version on the **About & Help** page of the settings editor.

CHAPTER 4

4 Quick start – your first snap

Three movements, about two seconds.



1. **Grab a window** by its title bar and hold the left mouse button.
2. **Move it up.** About 140 px below the top edge a small handle appears. Keep going until the cursor touches the top edge – the snap bar slides down.
3. **Point at a zone.** It lights up in your accent color, and a preview on the desktop shows where the window will land.
4. **Let go.** The window fills exactly that zone.

Changed your mind?

Move the cursor away from the bar, or release the window anywhere outside it. Nothing is snapped and the bar slides back up.

Which windows can snap?

Normal, resizable windows. Dialogs, fullscreen windows and apps on your exclusion list never show the snap bar.

Getting the old size back

Grab a snapped window and drag it away – it returns to the size it had before snapping. You can turn this off on the `General` page.

More than one screen?

The bar opens on the screen under the cursor, and zones fill that screen's free area – panels are left uncovered.

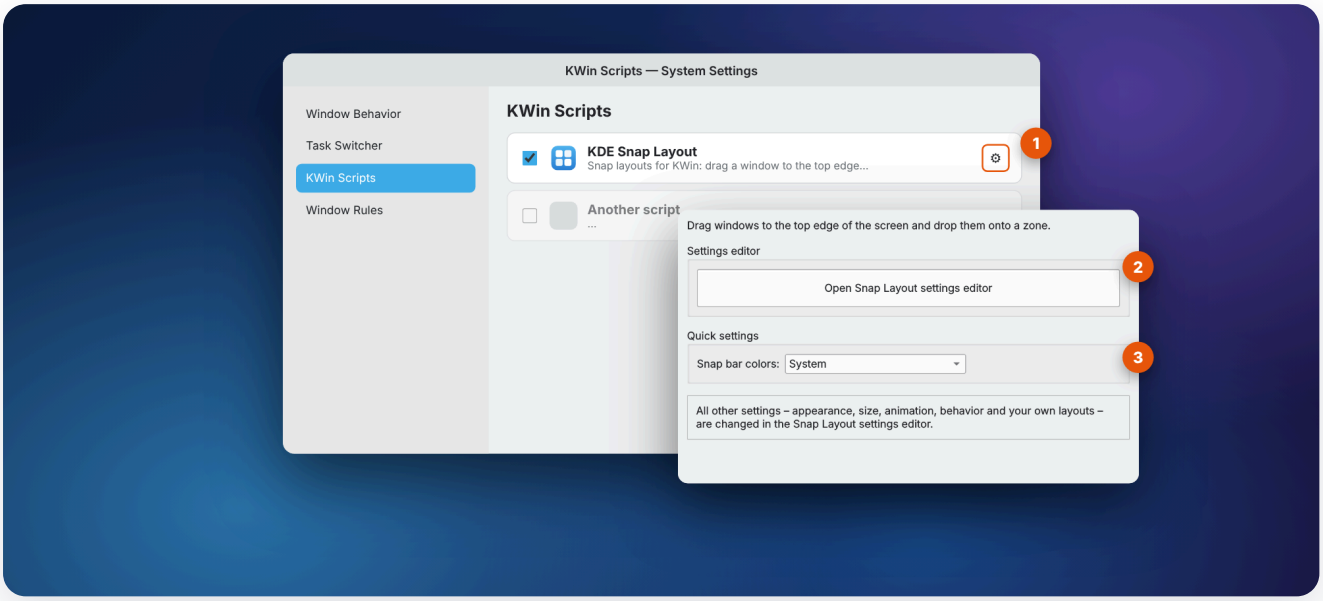
Smoother snapping

Plasma maximizes a window that is dragged to the top edge. For the best experience, turn that off: `System Settings` → `Window Management` → `Screen Edges` → untick `Maximize: Windows dragged to top edge` (the exact name can vary slightly between Plasma versions).

CHAPTER 5

5 Opening the settings

A KWin script has no app icon of its own. Its settings are reached through the gear icon in System Settings, which opens a small quick menu.



1. Open **System Settings** → **Window Management** → **KWin Scripts** and click the **gear icon** 1 next to **KDE Snap Layout**.
2. Click **Open Snap Layout settings editor** 2. The hint “Ready – click OK to open the settings editor.” appears.
3. Click **OK**. The settings editor opens within about a second.

Quick settings

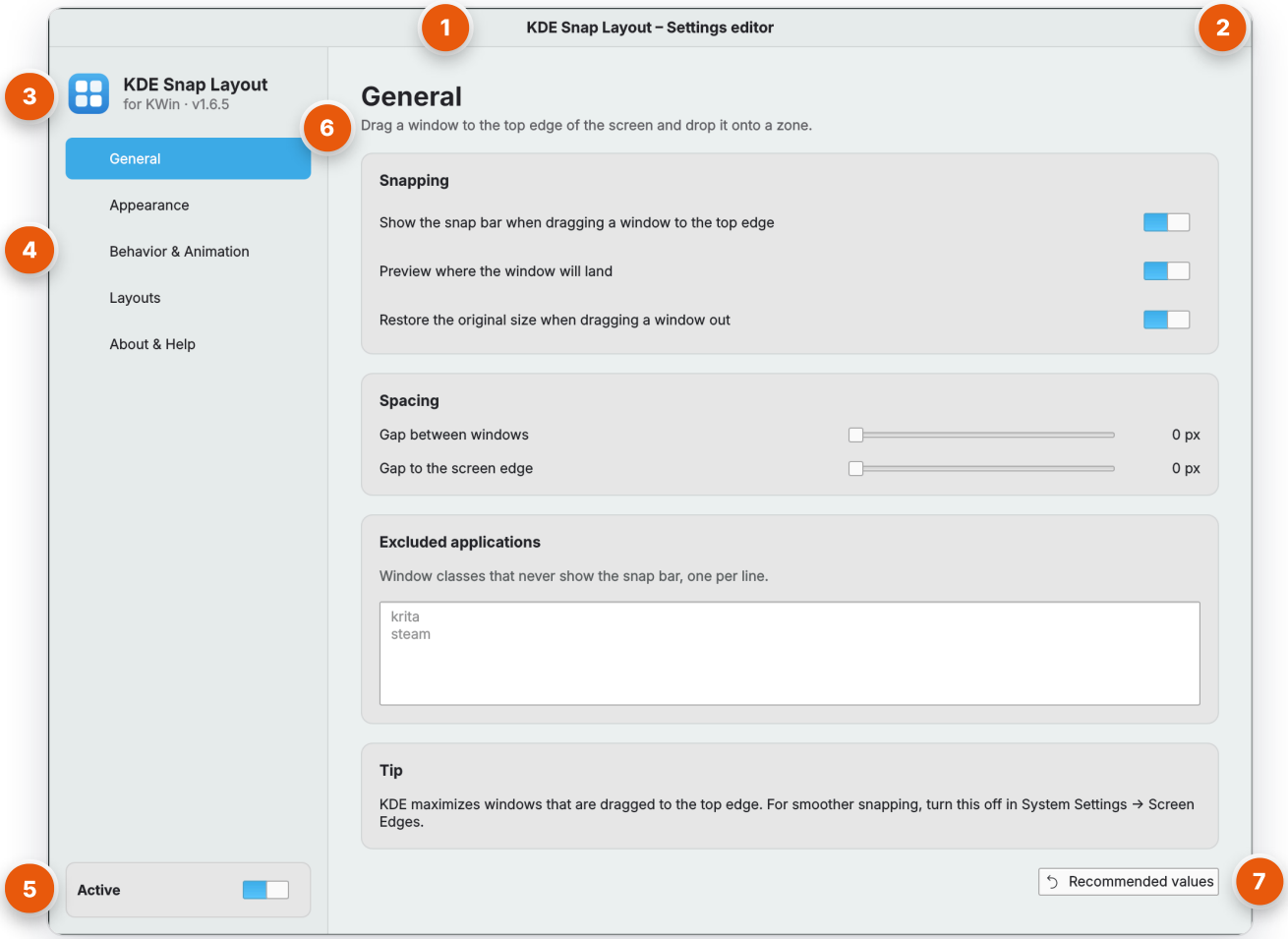
3 **Snap bar colors** switches the snap bar between **System**, **Light** and **Dark** without opening the editor. Everything else – appearance, size, animation, behavior and your own layouts – lives in the settings editor.

> **Why the extra click?**
> System Settings only saves the quick menu when you press **OK** or **Apply**. KDE Snap Layout notices the saved button press and opens its editor. The button can be used as often as you like.

CHAPTER 6

6 The settings editor

One window, five pages. Every change is saved and applied immediately – there is no Apply button.



1. **Title bar** – drag to move the window, double-click to maximize. Height, font and alignment follow your window decoration.
2. **Window buttons** – maximize/restore and close, in the order and style of your decoration.
3. **Name and version** of the installed script.
4. **Pages** – General, Appearance, Behavior & Animation, Layouts, About & Help.
5. **Active** – pauses or resumes the snap bar everywhere. Shows `Paused` while off.
6. **Page area** – settings are grouped in cards.
7. **Recommended values** – resets the settings of the current page to their defaults.

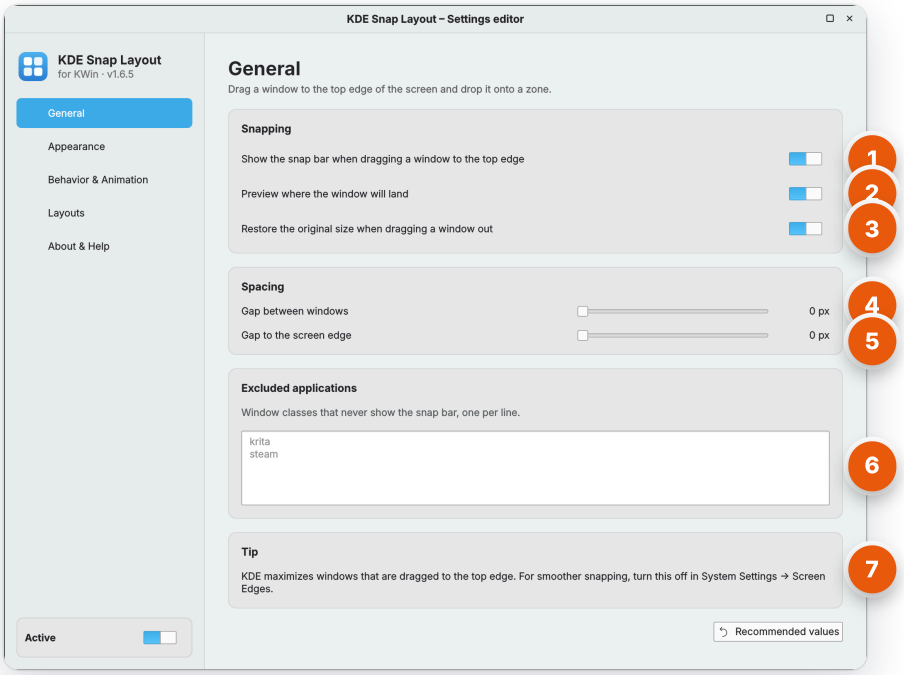
Resize it
Drag the right edge, the bottom edge or the bottom-right corner to make the window larger or smaller. Size and position are kept while the session runs.

Matches your system
The editor uses your color scheme, accent color, window decoration and system language – and follows changes live while it is open.

SETTINGS EDITOR

6.1 General

Switch snapping on or off, control the preview and leave room between windows.



Setting	What it does	Default	Range
1 **Show the snap bar when dragging a window to the top edge**	Main switch. Same as **Active** in the sidebar.	On	On / Off
2 **Preview where the window will land**	Shows the translucent landing rectangle while a zone is highlighted.	On	On / Off
3 **Restore the original size when dragging a window out**	A snapped window that you drag away gets its earlier size back.	On	On / Off
4 **Gap between windows**	Space between neighbouring zones. Use it for a tiling look.	0 px	0 – 48 px
5 **Gap to the screen edge**	Space between the zones and the edges of the free screen area.	0 px	0 – 48 px
6 **Excluded applications**	Window classes that never show the snap bar – one per line (commas and semicolons work too). Not case-sensitive.	empty	any text
7 **Tip**	Reminder to turn off Plasma's own maximize-at-top (see chapter 4).	–	–

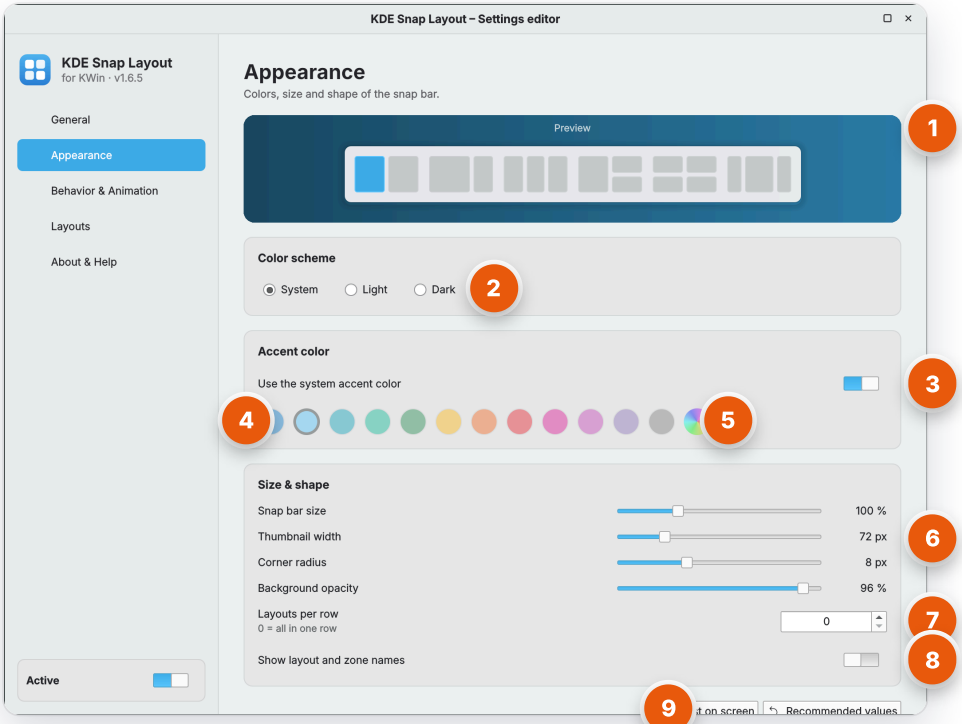
Finding a window class

Open **System Settings** → **Window Management** → **Window Rules** → **Add New…** → **Detect Window Properties** and click the app window. The value under **Window class** (for example `krita` or `steam`) is what you enter here.

SETTINGS EDITOR

6.2 Appearance

Colors, size and shape of the snap bar. The live preview at the top shows every change at once.

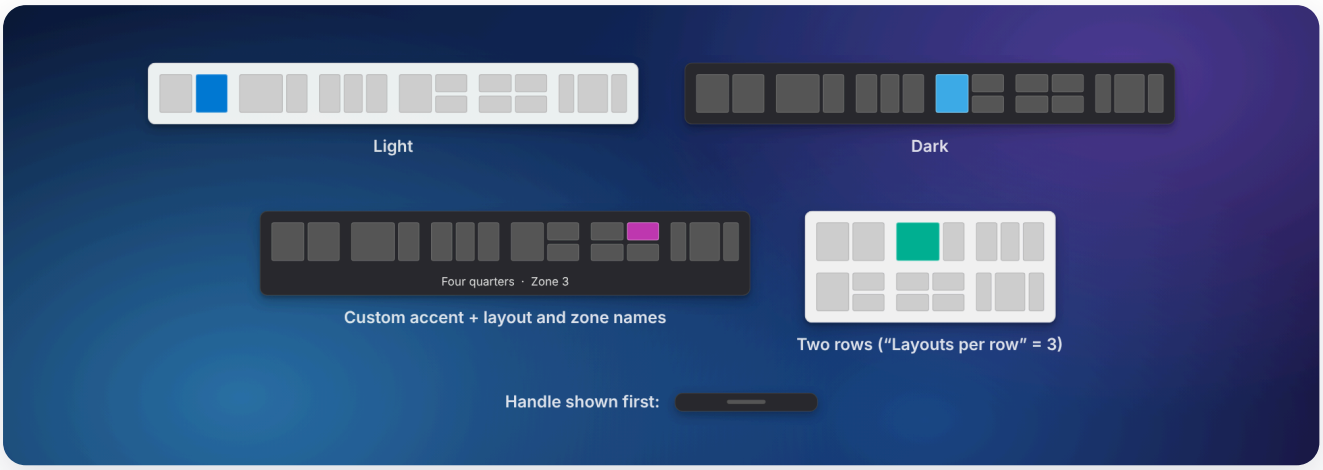


1. **Preview** of the snap bar with your current settings.
2. **Color scheme** – **System** follows your Plasma colors; **Light** and **Dark** are fixed. Default: System.
3. **Use the system accent color** – highlights zones in your Plasma accent. Default: on.
4. **Color swatches** – twelve ready-made accents. Turn off ③ first.
5. **Custom color** – the rainbow circle opens a color picker (see below).
6. **Size & shape** – four sliders, see the table.
7. **Layouts per row** – 0 shows all layouts in one row; any other number wraps the bar into several rows.
8. **Show layout and zone names** under the thumbnails. Default: off.
9. **Test on screen** plays the snap bar on your desktop so you can judge the result.

Size & shape	What it does	Default	Range
Snap bar size	Scales the whole bar – handy on high-resolution screens.	100 %	60 – 200 %
Thumbnail width	Width of each layout picture; the height follows your screen's shape.	72 px	48 – 160 px
Corner radius	Roundness of the bar. 0 gives square corners.	8 px	0 – 24 px
Background opacity	How see-through the bar background is.	96 %	40 – 100 %

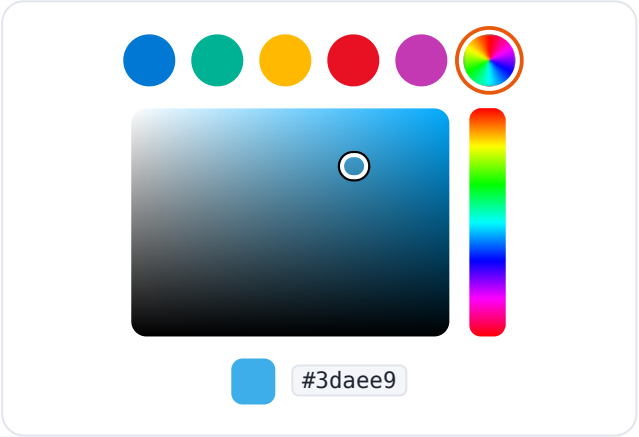
Colors and styles

A few combinations of the appearance settings.



Picking your own accent color

1. Turn off **Use the system accent color**.
2. Click the **rainbow circle** at the end of the swatches. The color picker opens below.
3. Choose the hue on the **strip**, then brightness and saturation in the **square**.
4. Or type an exact value such as `#3daee9` into the **hex field**.



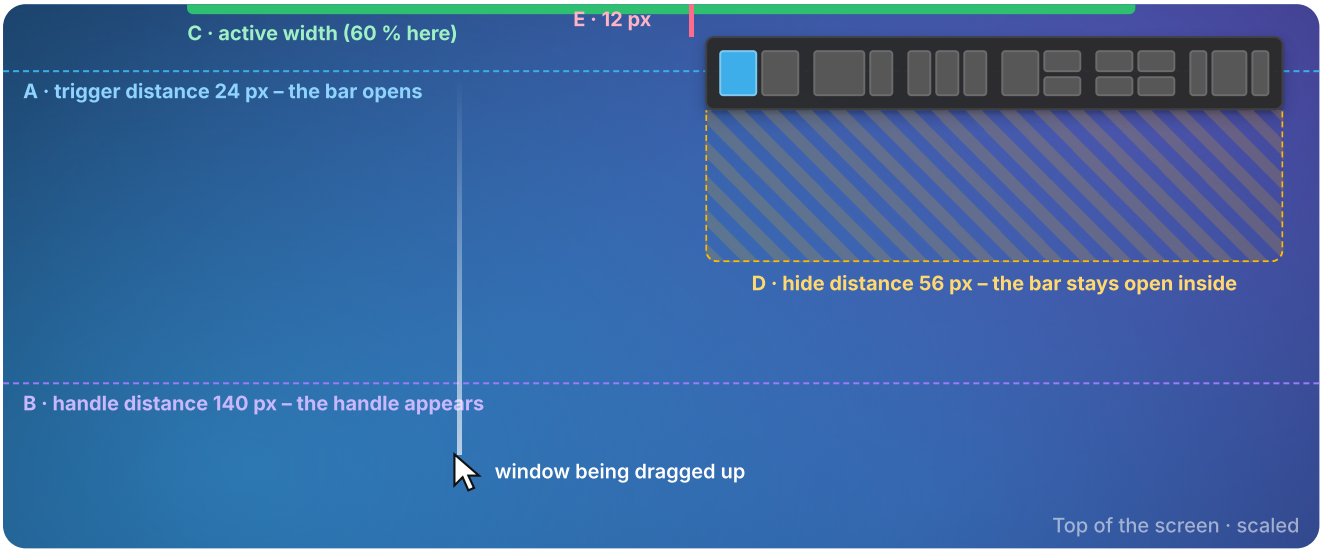
> **Snap bar vs. editor colors**
> The color scheme and accent on this page only change the **snap bar**. The settings editor itself always uses your system colors.

6.3

SETTINGS EDITOR

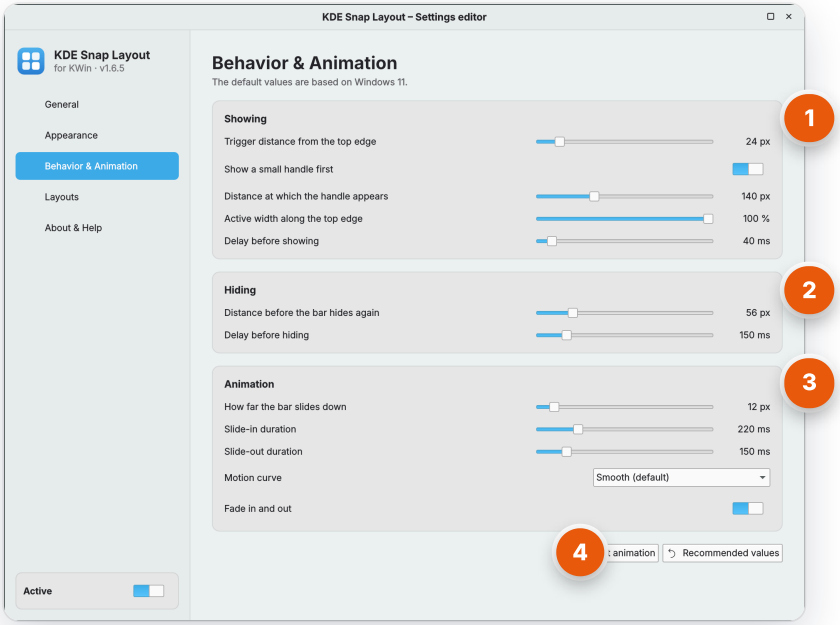
Behavior & Animation

When the bar appears, when it hides again and how it moves. The default values are based on Windows 11.



Showing	What it does	Default	Range
A Trigger distance from the top edge	How close the cursor must get to the top edge before the full bar opens.	24 px	2 – 200 px
Show a small handle first	Shows the handle on the way up, so the bar never pops up by surprise.	On	On / Off
B Distance at which the handle appears	Distance from the top edge at which the handle appears.	140 px	20 – 400 px
C Active width along the top edge	Only this centered part of the top edge reacts. 100 % = the whole width.	100 %	10 – 100 %
Delay before showing	Waiting time before the bar opens. Prevents opening while passing by.	40 ms	0 – 600 ms

Hiding	What it does	Default	Range
D Distance before the bar hides again	How far you can move below the bar before it closes – a safety margin.	56 px	0 – 300 px
Delay before hiding	Waiting time after leaving that area before the bar slides up.	150 ms	0 – 1000 ms

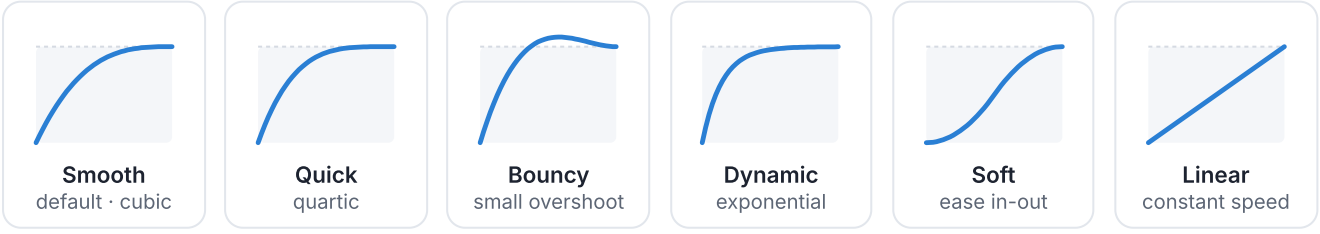


1. **Showing** – see the table on the previous page.
2. **Hiding** – see the table on the previous page.
3. **Animation** – see below.
4. **Test animation** plays the bar with the current values.

Animation	What it does	Default	Range
E **How far the bar slides down**	Distance between the top of the free screen area and the bar when it is open.	12 px	0 – 150 px
Slide-in duration	How long the bar takes to slide down.	220 ms	0 – 1000 ms
Slide-out duration	How long it takes to slide back up. Shorter feels snappier.	150 ms	0 – 1000 ms
Motion curve	The character of the movement – see the curves below.	Smooth	6 curves
Fade in and out	Fades the bar while it slides.	On	On / Off

Motion curves

Each curve has a matching reverse for sliding back up, so hiding feels like showing played backwards.

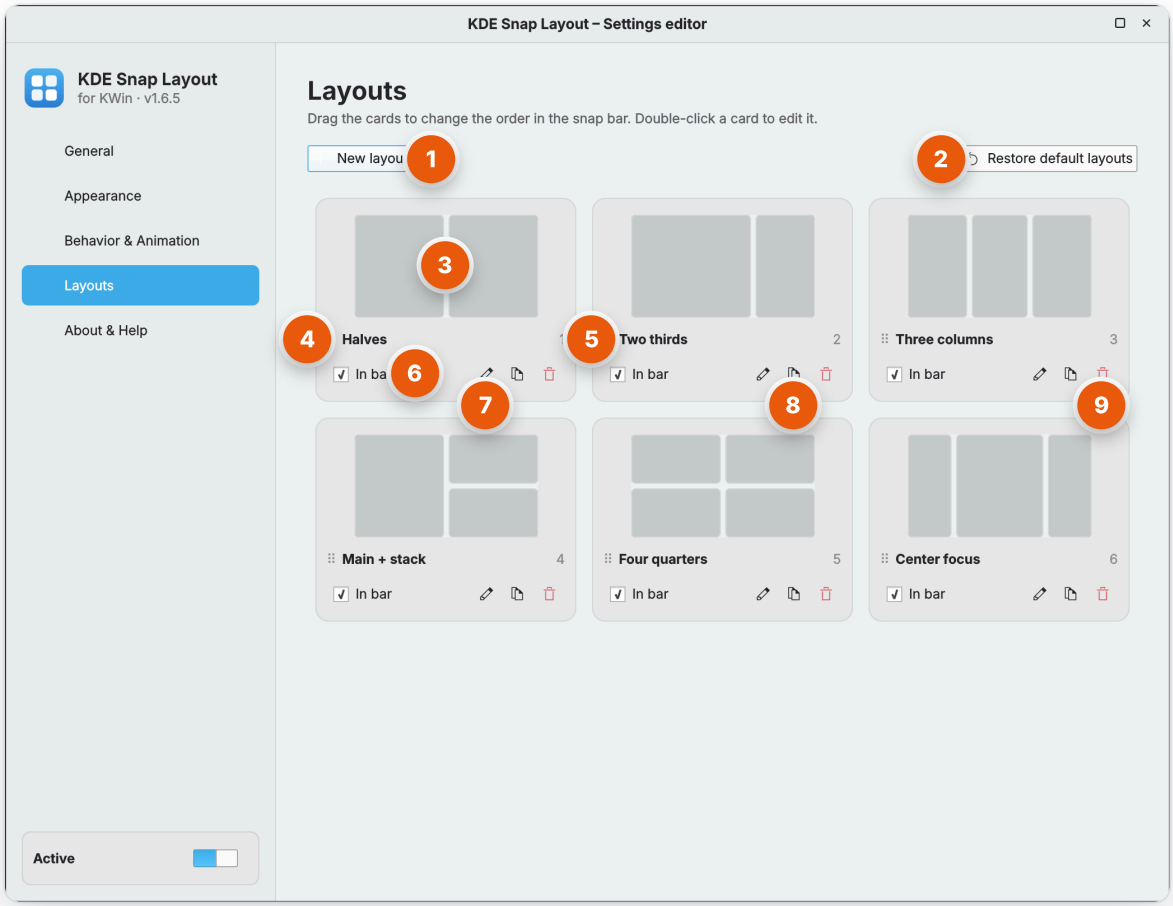


Slow PC or remote desktop?
Set both durations to 0 ms and turn off fading – the bar then appears instantly.

SETTINGS EDITOR

6.4 Layouts

Choose which layouts appear in the snap bar and in which order.



1. **New layout** – creates a layout and opens the designer.
2. **Restore default layouts** – brings back the six built-in layouts. Asks first, because your own layouts and order are lost.
3. **Layout card** – a picture of the layout. **Double-click** to edit it.
4. **Drag handle ⠿** – drag a card to another place to change the order in the bar.
5. **Position** in the snap bar (1 = left).
6. **In bar** – untick to hide a layout from the bar without deleting it.
7. **Edit ✎** – opens the layout designer (shown on card 1).
8. **Duplicate** – copies the layout as a starting point for a variant (card 2).
9. **Delete** – removes the layout after a confirmation (card 3).

Changing the order

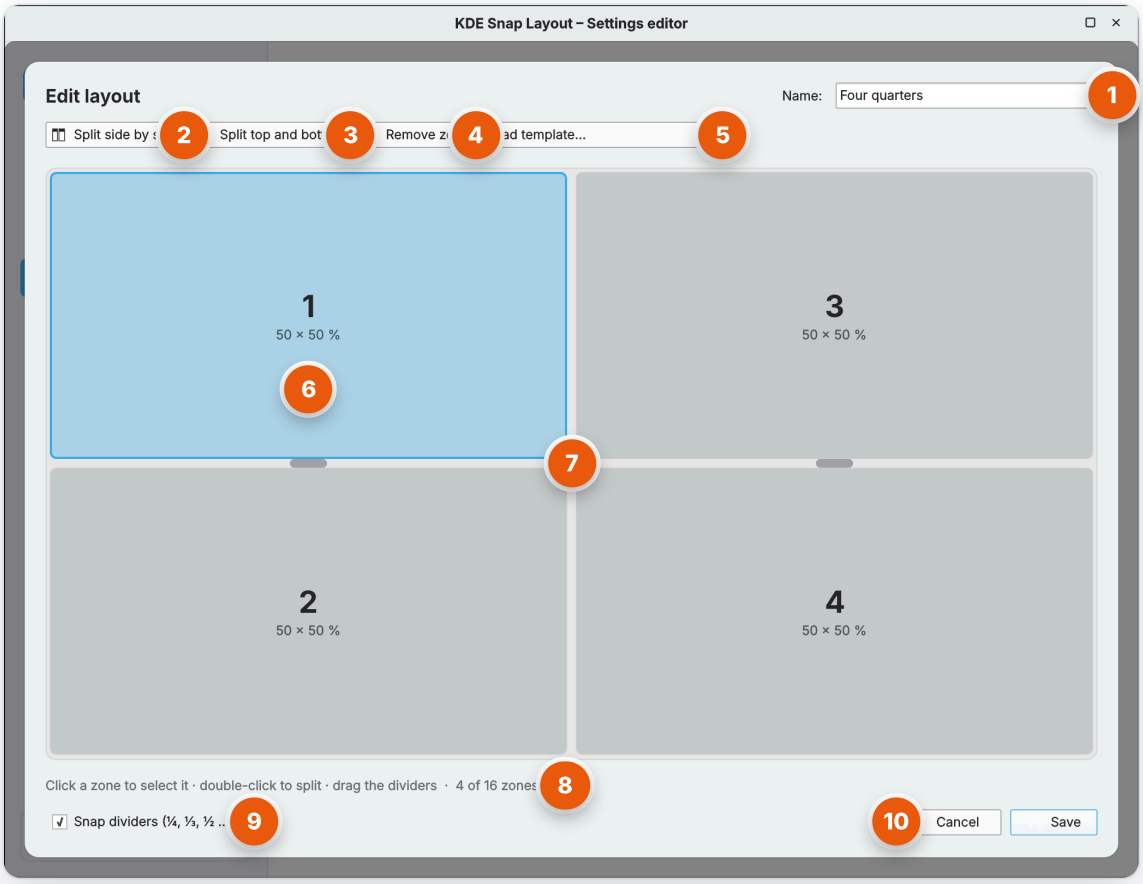
1. Press and hold the mouse button on a card.
2. Drag it onto the position where it should go – the other cards move aside.
3. Release. The new order is saved and used the next time the bar opens.

6.5

SETTINGS EDITOR

Layout designer

Split the screen any way you like – up to 16 zones per layout.



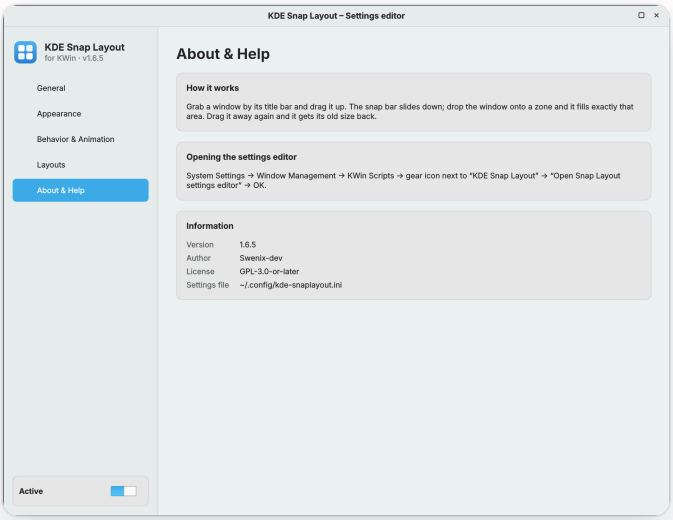
1. **Name** of the layout, shown on the card and in the name line.
2. **Split side by side** – cuts the selected zone into a left and a right half.
3. **Split top and bottom** – cuts the selected zone horizontally.
4. **Remove zone** – deletes the selected zone; its neighbour takes the space.
5. **Load template…** – starts from one of eleven ready-made layouts.
6. **Selected zone** – click a zone to select it. Number and size in % are shown inside. **Double-click** splits it along its longer side.
7. **Divider** – drag it to change the sizes of the zones on both sides.
8. **Zone counter** – shows how many of the 16 possible zones are used.
9. **Snap dividers** – dividers click into place at ¼, ⅓, ½, ⅔ and ¾.
10. **Cancel / Save** – discard or keep your changes.

Example: a large main area with two small zones on the right

1. Click **New layout** on the Layouts page and type a name, e.g. *Focus + 2*.
2. Click **Split side by side**, then drag the divider to ⅔.
3. Select the right zone and click **Split top and bottom**. Click **Save**.

SETTINGS EDITOR

6.6 About & Help



A short reminder of how snapping works and how to open the editor, plus:

- **Version** – the installed version. Check it after an update.
- **Author** – Swenix-dev
- **License** – GPL-3.0-or-later
- **Settings file** – where your settings and layouts are stored.

CHAPTER 7

7 Shortcuts & languages

Keyboard shortcuts

KDE Snap Layout registers two actions with KWin. They have no key assigned by default, so they never clash with your own shortcuts.

Action	What it does
KDE Snap Layout: turn on/off	Pauses or resumes snapping – the same as the **Active** switch.
KDE Snap Layout: test the snap bar	Plays the snap bar on the current screen.

To assign keys: **System Settings** → **Keyboard** → **Shortcuts** → **KWin**, search for "Snap Layout", select an action and press the new key combination.

Languages

The settings editor, the quick menu and the layout names follow your system language (**System Settings** → **Region & Language**). 62 languages are included – all European languages plus Chinese (simplified and traditional), Japanese, Korean, Hindi, Bengali, Tamil, Telugu, Marathi, Gujarati, Punjabi, Urdu, Arabic, Hebrew, Persian, Indonesian, Malay, Vietnamese, Thai, Filipino, Georgian, Armenian and more. Right-to-left languages are mirrored automatically.

> **Help translate**
> Each language is a plain text file in the `i18n` folder of the repository – one line per text. Corrections and new languages are welcome as pull requests.

CHAPTER 8

8 Recommended values

All defaults at a glance. **Recommended values** on each page restores them for that page.

General	
Show the snap bar	On
Landing preview	On
Restore original size	On
Gap between windows	0 px
Gap to the screen edge	0 px
Excluded applications	none
Appearance	
Color scheme	System
System accent color	On
Snap bar size	100 %
Thumbnail width	72 px
Corner radius	8 px
Background opacity	96 %
Layouts per row	0 (one row)
Layout and zone names	Off

Behavior	
Trigger distance	24 px
Small handle first	On
Handle distance	140 px
Active width	100 %
Delay before showing	40 ms
Hide distance	56 px
Delay before hiding	150 ms
Animation	
Slide distance	12 px
Slide-in duration	220 ms
Slide-out duration	150 ms
Motion curve	Smooth
Fade in and out	On

Layouts in the bar

Halves · Two thirds · Three columns · Main + stack · Four quarters · Center focus

CHAPTER 9

9 Troubleshooting & FAQ

Q The snap bar does not appear.

Check that the script is ticked in **KWin Scripts** and that **Active** is on in the editor. Make sure the app is not on your exclusion list and that you drag a normal, resizable window by its title bar. If **Active width along the top edge** is below 100 %, move towards the middle of the top edge.

Q The window gets maximized instead of snapped.

That is Plasma's own top-edge maximize. Turn it off under **Screen Edges** (see chapter 4).

Q I installed an update, but the old version is still running.

KWin keeps loaded scripts in memory. Log out and back in once. The **About & Help** page shows the running version.

Q The quick menu button does nothing.

After **Open Snap Layout settings editor** you have to click **OK** (or **Apply**). The editor appears about one second later.

Q "Could not locate package metadata" in KWin Scripts.

The script folder was removed while KWin still listed it. Install the `.kwinscript` file again, then log out and back in.

Q The bar opens too easily / not easily enough.

Lower the **Trigger distance** and raise **Delay before showing** to make it harder to open by accident – or the other way round.

Q Can I use it with several monitors?

Yes. The bar opens on the screen under the cursor and zones are calculated for that screen.

Q Something is still wrong – how do I report it?

Collect the log and open an issue on GitHub:

```
journalctl --user -b | grep kdesnaplayout | tail -n 30
```

CHAPTER 10

10 Files, uninstalling & license

Where things are stored

Path	Contents
`~/.config/kde-snaplayout.ini`	All settings of the editor and your layouts. Copy it to move your setup to another PC.
`~/.config/kwinrc` → `[Script-kdesnaplayout]`	The two quick-menu values (editor button, snap bar colors).
`~/.local/share/kwin/scripts/kdesnaplayout`	The installed script.

> **Privacy**
> KDE Snap Layout works completely offline. It sends no data anywhere and only reads window positions while you drag a window.

Uninstalling

In **KWin Scripts**, click the trash icon next to **KDE Snap Layout** and then **Apply**. Or in a terminal:

```
kpackagetool6 --type KWin/Script --remove kdesnaplayout
rm ~/.config/kde-snaplayout.ini        # optional: delete your settings
```

License

KDE Snap Layout is free software: you can redistribute it and/or modify it under the terms of the GNU General Public License, version 3 or (at your option) any later version. It is distributed in the hope that it will be useful, but without any warranty.

KDE Snap Layout
Made by **Swenix-dev**
Source & issues: github.com/Swenix-dev/KDE-Snap-Layout
Also on the KDE Store